



SMARTIE

Synergistic Management and Advancement of Artificial
Intelligence in European Higher Education

WP4 – Pilot Actions, Dissemination, Communication

T4.2. Dissemination Action Strategy – DAS

D.4.2.1. Dissemination Action Strategy

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1. Foreword

The integration of artificial intelligence into higher education is rapidly becoming a strategic priority for universities seeking to modernize teaching, learning, and curriculum development. As AI continues to influence professional practice, research, communication, healthcare, logistics, and engineering systems, higher education institutions are increasingly required to adapt their academic offer in order to prepare students for emerging technological, social, and labour market realities. In this context, the SMARTIE consortium undertook a structured analysis aimed at identifying the disciplines and subjects that can be meaningfully updated through the use of AI tools and AI-supported educational approaches. This report reflects a collaborative effort to explore how AI can enhance subject content, teaching methodologies, and the relevance of university programmes in several key domains. The selected fields—Engineering, Inland Navigation and Logistics, Communication Sciences, and Health and Environment—represent areas in which digital transformation is already generating substantial changes in knowledge requirements, professional competences, and operational practices. By identifying priority subjects for improvement, the consortium contributes to a forward-looking educational strategy that supports innovation, interdisciplinarity, and alignment with societal needs.

The present document therefore serves not only as a record of proposed subjects for update, but also as an important foundation for the next stages of the SMARTIE project, where selected disciplines will be further developed and improved using AI-related tools, methods, and pedagogical perspectives.

2. Introduction

The Dissemination Action Strategy (DAS) of the Synergistic Management and Advancement of Artificial intelligence in European Higher Education (SMARTIE) project outlines the approach, activities, and tools used to effectively communicate the project and disseminate its results.

The Plan is created to:

- define a clear and coherent approach to sharing information about the project and results during and beyond the project life cycle
- outline the strategy and specific activities to make the project's results accessible and reach a wide audience of relevant stakeholders, particularly, European universities.

This Plan can be adapted as necessary throughout the lifetime of the SMARTIE project.

3. SMARTIE's Approach to Dissemination and Communication

To ensure effective communication and dissemination, SMARTIE aligns with the European Commission's recommendations on project communication (2021) and adopts an approach that combines clear positioning, strategic storytelling, and targeted outreach. This approach centres on three key elements: Value Proposition, Branding Narrative, and the 5 Principles of Marketing (5Ps of Marketing). Together, these components guide the development of the strategy and provide a cohesive framework for communicating and disseminating project results.

3.1 Value proposition

The value proposition forms the foundation of the project's communication strategy by clearly articulating its unique benefits and outcomes. Using the Golden Circle, a model developed by Simon Sinek to understand how successful organizations communicate and inspire action, the project partners collaboratively define the value proposition by reflecting on its three layers of the Golden Circle: Why, How, and What (Figure 1).

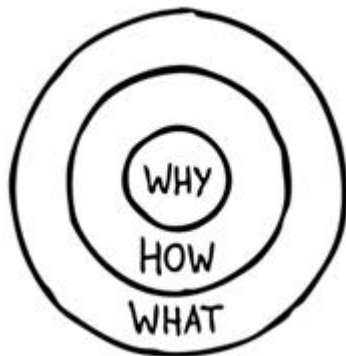


Figure 1 Golden Circle Model

WHY (Purpose): The core mission and purpose of the project. By starting with WHY, the project clarifies its deeper meaning and communicates its value clearly as it helps to:

- Develop purpose-driven messages that resonate deeply with the target groups.
- Align dissemination efforts with the values and needs of the stakeholders.
- Inspire stronger engagement by highlighting the meaningful impact the project aims to achieve.

HOW (Value Creation): How the project will bring its purpose to life and create value for the target groups and relevant stakeholders. It enables the project to:

- Define strategies that emphasize the project's uniqueness and impact.
- Engage target groups in a way that ensures lasting results.

WHAT (Results): The tangible outcomes and benefits delivered by the project. This includes:

- The measurable impact of the project's results.

- The benefits experienced by the target groups as a direct result of their involvement.

The exercise will result in a clear value proposition statement that serves as a key messaging tool to ensure stakeholders understand what the project does, how it benefits them, and why it matters.

3.2 Branding Narrative

A strong, cohesive branding narrative is essential for making our project relatable and engaging. Complementing the value proposition of the project, the branding narrative adds depth and context to the messaging by telling the bigger story behind the project. The project's branding narrative will build on the deeper connection that our stakeholders have with the issues we aim to solve, presenting our project not just as a set of actions, but as part of a broader, meaningful story.

By creating a compelling branding narrative, we not only communicate the 'Why' but also describe the attributes, values, and characteristics of the project. This inspires engagement, building trust and credibility with the project's relevant stakeholders. The narrative brings the project to life and allows stakeholders to feel part of its success.

3.3 5Ps of Marketing

Adapting the classical 4Ps and modern 6Ps of Marketing, the project will use 5Ps of Marketing (Product, Persona, Promotion, Place, and Presentation) to guide the organisation and design of strategies to communicate and disseminate the project effectively and meaningfully.



Figure 2 5Ps of Marketing Model

- **Product:** it refers to what is offered as a result of the project implementation, specifically the resources and tools developed throughout the project.

- **Persona:** it represents the target audience for the project and its impact. By identifying the various target groups, it helps to tailor messages and strategies that address their unique needs, preferences, and motivations.
- **Promotion:** it refers to how different strategies will be designed and used to communicate with and engage the defined target groups, encompassing both direct methods (e.g., email campaigns, newsletters, and events such as webinars and workshops) and indirect methods (e.g., social media posts, promotional videos, and media coverage such as blog articles on the website) to ensure broad reach and high levels of engagement.
- **Place:** in general, it refers to where the product will be offered. In this case, we use it to refer to the channels through which information and results will be shared, including both offline and online platforms such as events, social media, newsletters, and more.
- **Presentation:** it refers to how the project and results will be showcased. it includes the visual and conceptual representation of the project and its results, incorporating the identity and branding, and communication materials that align with the project's messaging and resonate with the target audience.

4. Our Value Proposition

The value proposition of the SMARTIE project was developed through a collaborative Golden Circle survey questioning with project partners after the Kick-Off meeting of the project in Craiova, Romania. This exercise facilitated alignment among partners on the project's core purpose, vision, and values. The results of the exercise are summarized below.

- Our WHY:
 - We support responsible AI integration in European higher education.
 - We help universities, educators, and students use AI's benefits while minimizing its risks.
 - We tackle challenges in ethical, inclusive, and effective AI adoption.
 - We develop unified strategies and best practices for AI use in teaching and learning.
 - We empower educators and students to apply AI responsibly and uphold academic integrity.
 - We create an inclusive digital education environment that benefits everyone.
 - We aim to make European higher education more competitive, innovative, and resilient.
- Our HOW:
 - We create unified strategies, AI-powered resources, and best practice guidelines to support responsible AI use.

- We bridge the digital skills gap with structured training, microlearning, and reverse learning methods.
- We enhance student learning and accessibility through AI-based assistive tools and personalized experiences.
- We help universities adopt AI efficiently with clear guidelines and shared recommendations.
- We promote ethical AI use by addressing risks like misinformation, deep fakes, and academic fraud.
- We build a strong academic alliance of higher education institutions across Europe to promote the integration of AI in educational processes.
- Our WHAT:
 - We deliver tangible results for ethical and inclusive AI integration in higher education.
 - We provide tools and strategies for effective AI adoption that ensure quality and integrity.
 - We establish a European Alliance for AI in Higher Education to foster collaboration and shared strategies.
 - We develop guidelines for teachers, researchers, and the public on responsible AI use.
 - We create AI-powered teaching tools and micro-courses to support educators.
 - We impact policymaking by offering national and European AI strategies for long-term harmonization and sustainability.

Based on the results, the value proposition for the SMARTIE project is established.

For universities, educators, students, and policymakers who seek to integrate AI into higher education while ensuring ethical, inclusive, and effective use, our AI-driven tools, guidelines, and training resources is a harmonized framework that enhances teaching, personalizes learning, promotes academic integrity, and prepares graduates for an AI-driven workforce.

This value proposition will serve as the cornerstone of the communication strategy for the SMARTIE project. It will guide all messaging and content creation, ensuring consistency in how the project's objectives are presented to different stakeholders.

5. Our Branding Narrative

The branding narrative of the SMARTIE project is derived directly from its value proposition, adding depth and context to the messaging by telling the larger story behind the project. While the value proposition defines what the project offers and its core benefits, the branding narrative places these elements within a broader context, creating a deeper connection with stakeholders.

Branding Narrative:

"At SMARTIE, we believe that higher education must lead the way in shaping an AI-driven future that is inclusive, ethical, and impactful. As AI rapidly transforms learning and teaching, universities need a structured approach to harness its potential while safeguarding academic integrity. SMARTIE bridges this gap by equipping educators, students, and policymakers with the knowledge, skills, and ethical frameworks needed to integrate AI responsibly.

Rooted in innovation and collaboration, SMARTIE fosters a harmonized approach to AI adoption in European higher education. We prioritize accessibility, inclusivity, and ethical integrity, ensuring AI enhances, not replaces the human-centered nature of education. Through practical resources, training workshops, and co-created guidelines, we empower universities to navigate AI's complexities while preparing students for a technology-driven workforce.

Transparency and collaboration are at the heart of SMARTIE. Working alongside educators, researchers, students, and industry stakeholders, we co-design strategies that address real challenges, ensuring our solutions are relevant, sustainable, and aligned with European values.

At its core, SMARTIE is about empowerment. By increasing awareness of AI's benefits and risks, we build a well-informed academic community capable of leading ethical AI practices. Our strategic alliances and capacity-building initiatives ensure that AI becomes a force for progress, equity, and lifelong learning.

SMARTIE is more than a project; it is a movement to shape the future of AI in higher education. By enhancing teaching, fostering innovation, and preparing institutions for the challenges ahead, we are paving the way for a smarter, fairer, and more inclusive education system."

Moreover, the branding narrative is also complemented by elements of visual identity. While the narrative itself focuses on the story and messaging behind the project, the visual identity serves as a representation of that narrative. Together, they create a cohesive and memorable brand that resonates with stakeholders.

Visual Identity

- Logo:

The logo symbolizes human-centric AI integration in European higher education. It features a human profile with neural-like circuits, representing intelligence and innovation. The colourful bar reflects diversity, collaboration, and multidisciplinary, highlighting a synergistic approach to managing and advancing AI across higher education institutions. A modern, clean font enhance the logo's connection to future-ready classrooms.



Figure 3 SMARTIE logo

- Colour Palette:

The colour palette features a vibrant sequence of cyan, yellow, magenta, purple, green, red, and sky blue. These bold, contrasting colours symbolize diversity, innovation, inclusion, and multidisciplinary, reflecting the dynamic collaboration between technology, people, and institutions in advancing AI within European higher education.



Figure 4 SMARTIE colour palette

- Font:

The SMARTIE project proposes Calibri (body) typefaces for a clean, professional look. A bold font conveys innovation and strength, while a lighter, more approachable typeface enhances readability and fosters a sense of collaboration. The balance between these fonts ensures the logo and messaging are both impactful and accessible.

Calibri

Figure 5 SMARTIE font

6. Our Dissemination Strategy

Once the value proposition and branding narrative have been established, the communication and dissemination strategies were structured using the 5Ps framework to create a concrete plan.

This framework ensures that the project's key messages are tailored to the right audience (Persona), effectively promoted (Promotion), delivered through the most appropriate channels (Place), and presented in a compelling, engaging way (Presentation), all while highlighting the core Product (the project's offerings and outcomes).

Product:

The main outputs of the projects that will be communicated and disseminated include:

- SMARTIE Alliance: A knowledge and innovation system comprising a network of universities and higher education stakeholders for knowledge-sharing on AI in higher education.
- SMARTIE Guidelines: Detailed guidelines for integrating AI across diverse higher educational contexts, ensuring accessibility for all, including teachers, researchers,

students with special educational needs and disabilities (SEND), and the general public.

- SMARTIE Training Program: Training workshops and resources designed to equip and orient educators regarding the development of new educational content using AI as co-pilot.
- European Strategy for Integration of AI in HE: A strategy document on actions for the ethical integration of AI in higher education that will be implemented beyond project lifetime
- National Strategies related to AI: 8 strategies developed for countries participating in project in order to support future national strategies for digitalization of education
- Other relevant WP results
- Other relevant information (blogs, interesting news) connected to the goal of SMARTIE

Persona (target audience):

- Academic – Teachers: Teachers need to improve their knowledge, skills and competences regarding the integration of AI as assistant tool for their academic activities.
- Academia – Researchers: Researchers are using generative AI in their desk research activities when prepare an experiment or elaborate state-of-art in specific topics. They will need to use accessible fact-checking tools to verify the authenticity of the information they encounter online. In addition, they have to avoid scientific fraud by citing the information provided by AI.
- Academia - students and SEND students: This target group usually use digital tools when developed individual projects or assignments provided by teachers.
- General Public: General Public face challenges in terms of fake news and deep fake. They will need to identify these threats in order to be able to preserve their way of life, privacy and quality of life as European citizens.

Promotion:

The strategies used to raise awareness, communicate about the project, and disseminate the project's key outputs while encouraging engagement include:

- Social Media Campaigns

The project will share its journey, milestones, key insights, industry news, and key outputs via SMARTIE LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram account channels. These campaigns will be aligned with the project's value proposition and branding narrative, ensuring that each post reinforces the core purpose of the project, highlights its impact, and engages stakeholders in a meaningful way. The messaging will reflect the project's innovative approach and collaborative nature, building trust and encouraging active participation.

- Partnership Communication

This includes project promotion and regular updates on the websites and communication channels of partner organizations. Each partner will contribute efforts to promoting the SMARTIE project in their chosen communication channels i.e. their organization social media post, their own newsletter, website blog article, etc.

- Webinars

A total of 1 webinar will be organized for 100 participants to disseminate project results. The webinar will showcase the project results and also aim to directly engage the target audience.

- Conferences and Publications:

Publication of 3 scientific articles in international journals to share project results. Participation in national and international conferences to present project results is encouraged.

The details of all promotional activities can be found in the Communication and Dissemination Schedule in Appendix 1.

Place:

For this SMARTIE project, we aim to use both online platforms and physical spaces where the target audience can learn about the project, receive updates on project developments, access the outputs, and exchange experiences.

- Website

A project website has been created: <https://project-smartie.eu/>

The website includes information about the project goals, downloadable project results, details about the partners and links to their platforms, project news, and buttons to contact the consortium about the project. A download tracker will be added to the website to monitor the downloads of the project's results, and analytics will be implemented to track unique visitors to the site.

UCV will update the website with relevant content as the project progresses and ensure that all queries received via the contact button are shared in the monthly meetings. The website is expected to be maintained for a minimum of 2 years beyond the end of the funding period.

- LinkedIn, Facebook, Twitter, and YouTube

The project has established LinkedIn, Facebook, Instagram, and YouTube account:

Twitter: https://x.com/SMARTIE_Project

Facebook: <https://www.facebook.com/share/1AunU4ongX/>

LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/company/smartie-project/posts/?feedView=all>

Instagram:

<https://www.instagram.com/smartie.project?igsh=MWQ1ZmI3djc1bDlxNw%3D%3D>

These social media channels have been chosen by the project during the proposal writing stage as they resonate deeply with the targeted audience. A total of 1 post per month will be published on each of the channels, with each partner taking turns contributing to the content. The editorial plan can be found in Appendix 1. UM will reach out to the partner responsible for creating the content at least a week before the scheduled posting dates and send a template for creating the posts.

The posts will be written in English and should be highly engaging, accompanied by at least one photo provided by the partner creating the content. Please ensure that the source of the image is included, and if it was taken by someone, permission has been received and proper credit is given.

The posts will also include relevant hashtags and the project hashtag: *#SMARTIE*, *#Erasmusplus*, *#Artificialintelligence*, *#AI*, *#Highereducation*.

See the Communication and Dissemination Schedule in **Appendix 1. Dissemination Schedule** for more details.

- Partners' Chosen Communication Channel

In addition to the official project digital platforms i.e. website, LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram, each project partners are encouraged to use their own communication channels to maximize visibility and engagement with the target audience and their networks.

For social media posts, partners will support the project's social media efforts by reposting project-related content and boosting posts through their individual LinkedIn, Facebook or Twitter accounts. This will help extend the project's reach to a wider audience beyond the immediate followers of the official project Please ensure the project hashtag is used.

Partners are also encouraged to share the project's news updates, event announcements, and key milestones, and the project results also on their own platforms i.e. website or another digital platform used. Each partner will follow the agreed Branding Narrative of the project and the European Commission requirements to maintain consistency in messaging, branding, and tone across all communication.

- Offline (Physical space)

In addition to the online platforms, the project will organise 18 workshops for disseminating project results and in-person engagement with the target audience. Each partner will organize a total of 2 workshops within their local regions and attended by 20 participants in total. The workshops will provide opportunities for the target audience to directly interact with the project team, gain insights into the project's progress, and participate in discussions and knowledge-sharing activities. All partners will distribute the hard copy quiz and e-quiz to be filled during national workshops and online for further project results analysis and improvements.

Presentation

A well-managed brand is an important part of strengthening the SMARTIE project's presence and engagement. The visual identity of the project has been developed in alignment with the project's branding narrative, ensuring that all visual elements reflect the core messaging and values. To maintain consistency and coherence, a Branding Manual will be created by FHOO, providing partners with clear guidelines on how to use the visual identity across all platforms and materials. This includes the appropriate use of the logo, colour palette, typography, imagery, and iconography. By incorporating these visual elements in presentations, reports, and communications, we ensure that the project's results are effectively conveyed, and the brand's impact is reinforced with each interaction

- Logo

The SMARTIE logo must be included on all publications. When adding the logo, please ensure that it is not cropped, overlapped, manipulated (e.g. stretched), and that the clear space is maintained as directed in the Brand Manual. It is important to make sure that the logo is not altered as this will maintain consistency across all publications.

- Partner Logos

The logos will be available on Synology and should be used on the main project results.

- Colour Palette

Use the primary colours from the logo for main elements like titles, headings, and important text (such as call-to-action phrases). This keeps the visual identity consistent and reinforces brand recognition. Apply the colour palette to graphs, charts, and diagrams to ensure the presentation maintains a cohesive visual identity. Use contrasting colours for different categories or data sets.

Choose neutral or light tones from the colour palette for backgrounds to maintain readability. These colours can be used in header or footer sections and slide backgrounds to ensure clarity. For texts, use a darker shade of the primary colour for body text to maintain readability and avoid using too many contrasting colours in one area of the slide or page.

- Fonts

The working font of the project is Calibri (body). This font is user-friendly and complimentary to the one project brand. It is available in Microsoft Suite and should be used as the main font in Word and PowerPoint.

- Iconography and Imagery

The project graphics and images have been pre-selected and are available in the shared Synology folder for partners to use as needed. They have been identified as fitting with the project branding narrative and are either open access or images for which a partner or partners have a license to use.

7. EC Open Access and GDPR Compliance

The project is legally required to acknowledge EU funding on any communications and published materials (i.e. “websites, media relations, conferences, seminars, information material such as brochures, leaflets, posters, presentations, etc”) by including the European flag and funding statement, as well as a disclaimer in the appropriate language (EECEA, 2023). This logo should be clearly visible, not cropped or altered, not overlapped by other text/images, nor changed in colour. Information regarding requirements and directions for use can be found via the European Commission website. The logo (available on the project shared folder in Synology is shown below:



**Co-funded by
the European Union**

Figure 6 EU logo used in the SMARTIE project

The following funding statement should be included on all publications:

“Co-funded by the Erasmus+ Programme of the European Union. Views and opinions expressed are however those of the author or authors only and do not necessarily reflect those of the European Union or the Foundation for the Development of the Education System. Neither the European Union nor the entity providing the grant can be held responsible for them.”

In order to safeguard accessibility and direct how project results are licensed for future use, published materials will have a Creative Commons (CC) license. The recommended license is CC BY-SA (allows for distribution, remixing, adaptation, and building upon materials, but only if credit is given to the SMARTIE project as the creator of the materials, and only under the same terms). Partners need to agree on this cc license.

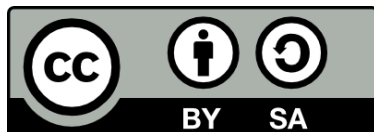


Figure 7 CC BY-SA Badge

Moreover, as there will be also external collection of personal data during the lifespan of the project, specific rules will be applied according to the [General Data Protection Regulation \(GDPR\)](#), following the Directive 2002/58/EC35 concerning the processing of personal data and the protection of privacy in electronic communications (Directive on privacy and electronic communications or e-Privacy Directive). Target groups, interested parties and any participants in the project dissemination activities will be informed accordingly.

8. Diversity, Inclusion, Accessibility

In order to ensure the SMARTIE project reaches the greatest and most inclusive target audience, dissemination activities will use whenever possible:

- diverse and representative images,
- alternative text when images are used,
- clear typography (namely, the project fonts Calibri as directed in the Branding Manual)
- clear colour contrast and not using colour alone to convey information,
- clear language,

- gender inclusive pronouns, terms, titles, and imagery,
- person-first language,
- feedback from all target groups,
- accessible locations/venues for in-person events,
- real-time transcription for online events,
- multiple digital platforms, as well as some print materials, to reach the broadest audience possible.

9. Roles and Responsibilities of Partners in Dissemination

The success of the dissemination of the SMARTIE project relies on a collaborative approach, with clearly defined roles and responsibilities for each partner:

- UCV (Project Leader)
 - Oversee the dissemination planning and implementation to ensure alignment with the project's overall objectives and timelines
 - Manage the project website
 - Facilitate discussions and resolve conflicts/disagreements related to communication and dissemination of the project
- UM (Dissemination Coordinator)
 - Coordinate the implementation of the dissemination strategy and update/ make revisions when necessary.
 - Collect content from all partners for posting on social media
 - Monitor dissemination activities to ensure compliance with the requirements of the proposal
 - Report the dissemination activities implemented and the results to the Project Coordinator for project reporting purposes.
- POLIBA will elaborate database for activities reported by partners (dissemination tracker). See more in **Appendix 2. Dissemination Tracker**
- FHOO will create social media and project branding manual, including hashtags project visual identity, logo, font, colour palette, tagline/ slogan, and hashtags. See more in **Appendix 3. Dissemination Visual Objects**
- UCV and FHOO will develop strategy for visual identification objects, especially for SEND students, in order to increase project visibility. See more in **Appendix 4. Strategy for visual identification objects**
- UZ and UL will develop strategy related to organising national workshops and international webinar. See more in **Appendix 5. Strategy for workshops, conferences, webinars**

- UBB will develop strategy to support European Initiatives related to adoption of AI in HE. See more in **Appendix 6. Strategy to support European Initiatives related to adoption of AI in HE.**
- All Project Partners
 - Take turns creating contents for SMARTIE social media accounts
 - Implement dissemination activities specific to their roles, as outlined in the proposal (see WP 4 in proposal)
 - Contribute to the creation of content related to their specific activities/tasks
 - Support the overall promotion of the project and dissemination of the project results within their network
 - Provide information/insights on their promotion and dissemination activities to POLIBA

10. KPIs

The following are the KPIs required for Dissemination as part of WP 4:

No.	KPIs	Overall Target
1	# of Dissemination Action Strategy (DAS)	1
2	# of national strategies related to AI	8
3	# of people who receive e-questionnaire related to draft version of European Strategy for Integration of AI in HE	150
4	# of answers received related on the draft version	150
5	# of workshops organized	18
6	# of participants to workshops	180
7	# of people who receive e-questionnaire related to quality of the workshops	180
8	# of answers received related to quality of the workshops	180
9	# of people who receive e-questionnaire related to quality of project results	180
10	# of answers received related to quality of the results	180
11	# of webinars organized	1
12	# of participants to webinar	100
13	# of articles published in international journals	3
14	# of posts on LinkedIn	31
15	# of posts on Facebook	31
16	# of posts of Instagram	31
17	# of videos of YouTube	18
17	# of followers on LinkedIn	30
18	# of followers in Facebook	30
19	# of followers on Instagram	30
20	# of report on quality of European Strategy for Integration of AI in HE (survey among teachers/trainees)	1

21	# of report on achievement of activities stated in the DAS	1
22	# of report on quality of activities related to consulting academic on quality of products during and after national workshops	1

11. Main Deliverables of Dissemination

To ensure that the dissemination of the project is well-coordinated and effectively implemented, the following deliverables are coordinated by the Dissemination Leader: UM.

- Dissemination Action Strategy
- Branding manual media use: project visual identity, logo, typography, colour palette, tagline/ slogan, and hashtags
- Design and communication templates: PowerPoint presentation slide, Word A4 document, flyers, posters, banners, etc.
- Dissemination Channels where the results and promotion contents will be shared: website, LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram.
- Dissemination Schedule
- Dissemination Log/ Tracker
- Strategy for organising national workshops and international webinar
- Strategy to support European initiatives related to adoption of AI in HE

12. References

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13. List of Appendixes

Appendix 1. Dissemination Schedule

Appendix 2. Dissemination Tracker

Appendix 3. Dissemination Visual Objects

Appendix 4. Strategy for visual identification objects

Appendix 5. Strategy for workshops, conferences, webinars

Appendix 6. Strategy to support European Initiatives related to adoption of AI in HE

13.1 Appendix 1. Dissemination Schedule

Year 1: 2025

All SMARTIE project results should be shared on social media channels as they become available. In the absence of new results, the suggested topics can guide the creation of engaging content for posting. In essence, available project results should be the core of each social media post. However, whenever, no result is available, partners may post interesting blogs or news on topics related to the central point of the SMARTIE project. Topic suggestions are provided below.

Month	Place	Type	Topics or Available Project Results	Target audience	Number of posts	Partner in charge of creating content	Deadline
June	LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram	Posts: Text with image/video	Introducing the SMARTIE project and its goals	HE teachers, researchers, students, SEND students, and the general public	1	All partners	June 30
July	LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram	Posts: Text with image/video	Meet the SMARTIE consortium: Introducing the project partners	Ditto	1	ACEEU	July 31
August	LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram	Posts: Text with image/video	The significance of AI in higher education: Current trends and future directions	Ditto	1	POLIBA	Aug 31
Sept	LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram	Posts: Text with image/video	The ethical implications of AI in higher education	Ditto	1	UL	Sept 30
Oct	LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram	Posts: Text with image/video	Benefits/ challenges of adopting AI in the classroom.	Ditto	1	FHOO	Oct 31

Nov	LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram	Posts: Text with image/video	How AI can make education more inclusive and accessible	Ditto	1	UBB	Nov 31
December	LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram	Posts: Text with image/video	Case studies of AI successfully transforming education	Ditto	1	UZ	Dec. 30

Year 2: 2026

Month	Place	Type	Topics/ Theme	Target audience	Number of post	Partner in Charge	Deadline
January	LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram	Posts: Text with image/video	Posts on LTT for teachers	Ditto	1	ULISBOA	January 31
February	LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram	Posts: Text with image/video	Guidelines for students	Ditto	1	UMA	February 29
March	LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram	Posts: Text with image/video	Guideline for the general public	Ditto	1	UCV	March 31
April	LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram	Posts: Text with image/video	Guideline for teachers and researchers	Ditto	1	ACEEU	April 30
May	LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram	Posts: Text with image/video	Videos for SEND students	Ditto	1	UMA	May 31
June	LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram	Posts: Text with image/video	National Strategies related to AI	Ditto	1	UL	June 30
July	LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram	Posts: Text with image/video	How SMARTIE's European strategy will shape the future of AI in academia	Ditto	1	FHOO	July 31
August	LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram	Posts: Text with image/video	Exploring the role of AI in microlearning: SMARTIE's innovative approaches.	Ditto	1	UBB	August 30

September	LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram	Posts: Text with image/video	Cross-disciplinary AI integration: A spotlight on updated academic disciplines	Ditto	1	UZ	September 30
October	LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram	Posts: Text with image/video	Key project milestones or updates	Ditto	1	ULISBOA	October 31
November	LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram	Posts: Text with image/video	Key project milestones or updates	Ditto	1	POLIBA	November 30
December	LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram	Posts: Text with image/video	Upcoming SMARTIE workshops and how to participate	Ditto	1	UCV	December 31

Year 3: 2027

Month	Place	Type	Topics/ Theme	Target audience	Target Number	Partner in Charge	Deadline
January	18 National Workshops	Workshop	To spread project results	Ditto	180 participants	ACEEU	January 31
February	LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram	Posts: Text with image about Workshop	Stories from workshop participants: Real-world impacts of SMARTIE	Ditto	1 post	UMA	February 28
March	LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram	Posts: Text with image/video	Key project milestones or updates	Ditto	1	UL	March 31
April	LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram	Posts: Text with image/video	Key project milestones or updates	Ditto	1	FHOO	April 30
May	LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram	Posts: Text with image/video	Key project milestones or updates	Ditto	1	UBB	May 31
June	LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram	Posts: Text with image/video	Key project milestones or updates	Ditto	1	UZ	June 30
July	LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram	Posts: Text with image/video	Key project milestones or updates	Ditto	1	ULISBOA	July 31

August	LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram	Posts: Text with image/video	Upcoming SMARTIE webinars and how to participate	Ditto	1	POLIBA	August 31
September	1 International webinar	Online event	To spread project results	Ditto	100 participants	UCV	Sept 30

13.2 Appendix 2. Dissemination Tracker

The dissemination activities will be recorded using forms allocated to SMARTIE partners. The forms have been developed as individual sheets for each partner and consolidated into a dissemination tracker database.

The dissemination tracker is an online tool that serves to partners for their dissemination activities reports. The main information supported by Dissemination Tracker tool are:

1. Information

Information about this tool:

- This tool is designed to streamline the reporting process of communication and dissemination stats from all partners.
- Being a common work document, full accessibility is guaranteed to all partners at any given moment.
- Specifically for online dissemination, please mention the overall estimated reach of your communication
- Partners are recommended to fill their dissemination sheet on a need basis, i.e. whenever any dissemination activities have been carried out at local, national, international/EU level - both via offline and offline means. Partners have the responsibility to make sure their data and inputs are easy to read, easy to understand.
- The Dissemination Tracker file is a living document posted on SMARTIE cloud where each partner can fill/upload the dissemination materials in order to achieve the project objectives.

2. Total dissemination target




Communication and Dissemination Tracker

Dissemination activities	Overall Target	Status
# of workshops organized	18	0
# of webinars organized	1	0
# of articles published in international journals	3	0
# of webinars organized	1	0
# of posts on LinkedIn	31	0
# of posts on Facebook	31	0
# of posts of Instagram	31	0
# of videos of YouTube	18	0
# of press release	-	0
# other	-	0

Dissemination task distribution	Dissemination KPI								
	# of workshops organized	# of webinars organized	# of articles published in international	# of webinars organized	# of posts on LinkedIn	# of posts on Facebook	# of posts of Instagram	# of videos of YouTube	# of press release
Partners									
UCV									
ULISBOA									
ACEEU									
UL									
UZ									
POLIBA									
UM									
FHO									
UBB									

3. SMARTIE partners reports

SMARTIE partner reports are tracked using SMARTIE Dissemination Activities Monitoring Forms where, SMARTIE partners can report their dissemination and communication activities. The living document is a powerful tool and allow to SMARTIE consortium to assess the performance of dissemination actions.



SMARTIE Dissemination Activities Monitoring Form

Name of the project: SMARTIE
Project Number:2024-1-RO01-KA220-HED-000244949

N.	WHEN (yyyy/mm/dd)	ACTIVITY		WHERE AND HOW		TARGET GROUP	
		Type	Name/Title	Type	Description	EU /Nat/Loc level	Description (e.g. General audience, Higher education institutions, students, industry professionals, policymakers, investors & funders)
4	20.11.2024	press release	SMARTIE Start	TV footage	Craiova	National	General audience, HEIs, students
5	14.11.2025	workshop	SMARTIE@ADEM Conference	Workshop	Drobeta Turnu Severin	International	HEIs, students, researchers
6							

13.3 Appendix 3. Dissemination Visual Objects

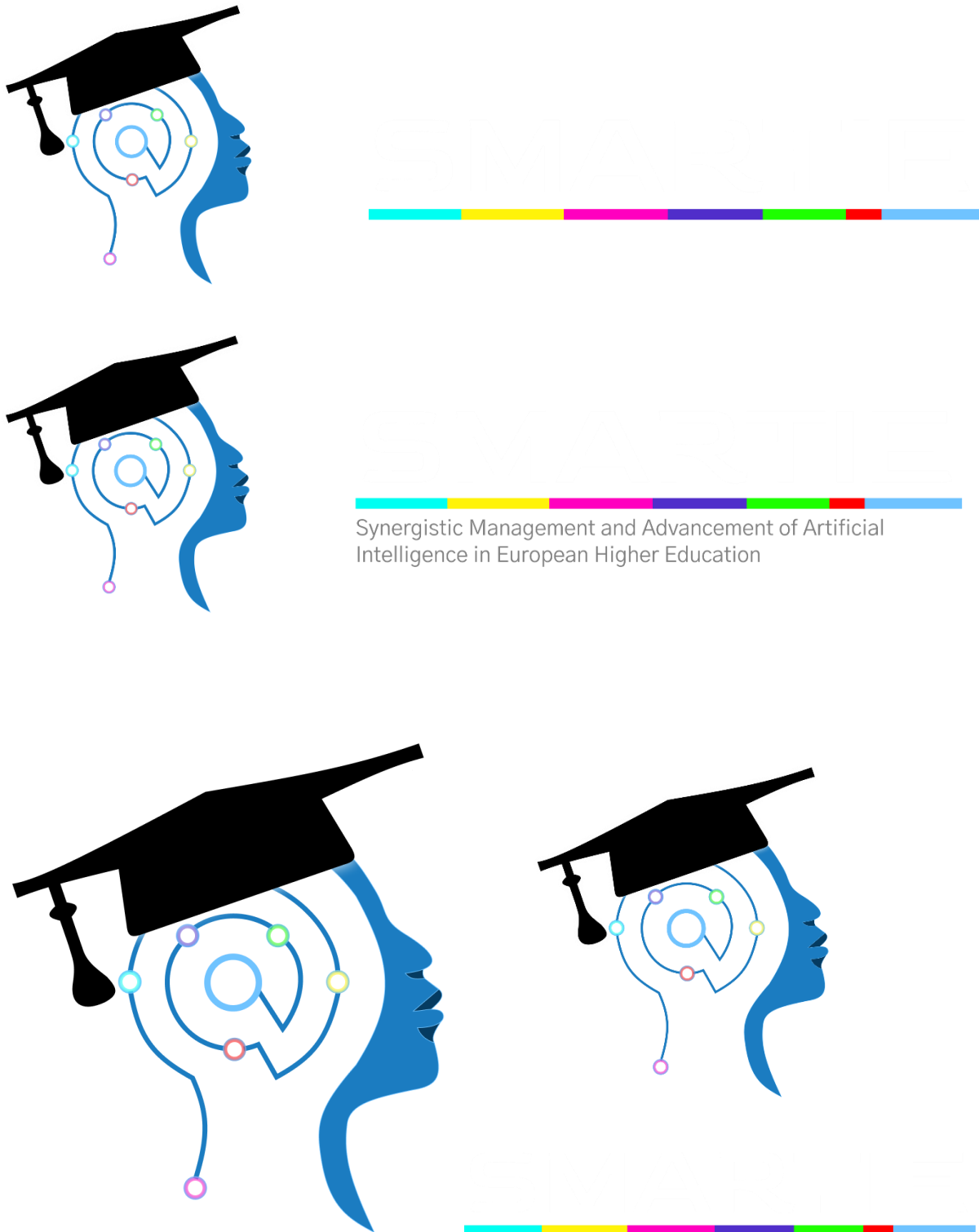


Figure 8 Visual objects for SMARTIE dissemination

13.4 Appendix 4. Strategy for visual identification objects

This strategy aims to define a coherent system of visual identification objects that makes an Erasmus+ project more visible, recognizable, understandable, and welcoming, especially for SEND students and their families, teachers, and stakeholders.

1. Introduction

SMARTIE project becomes truly visible only when its identity can be recognized consistently across physical spaces, learning materials, events, digital media, and community interactions. For SEND students, visibility must go beyond conventional branding. It must support orientation, reassurance, belonging, and comprehension. What is necessary to do:

- use clear and repeatable visual signals rather than abstract communication only;
- reduce cognitive overload through simple, predictable, high-contrast design;
- make project participation visible in classrooms, workshops, events, online channels, and outreach materials;
- ensure that project identity is inclusive for students with learning difficulties, autism spectrum conditions, sensory sensitivities, attention challenges, or communication barriers;
- convert accessibility into a visible asset of the project, thereby improving trust, dissemination impact, and institutional reputation.

2. Strategic aims and objectives

2.1. Aim

SMARTIE strategy for visual identification objects aims to create and implement a unified family of visual identification objects that enhances the public visibility of the Erasmus+ project while making participation easier and safer for SEND students.

2.2. Specific objectives

The specific objectives of this strategy for visual identification objects are:

- Increase recognition of the project brand across all learning and dissemination environments.
- Provide SEND-friendly cues that facilitate orientation, predictability, and emotional comfort.
- Standardize the appearance of project objects so that every partner institution communicates the same identity.
- Improve the quality of events, workshops, pilot activities, and mobility actions through accessible visual supports.
- Generate shareable, photogenic, and stakeholder-friendly materials that strengthen dissemination and long-term project legacy.

3. Design principles

The main design principles of SMARTIE strategy for visual identification objects are presented in Figure 9.

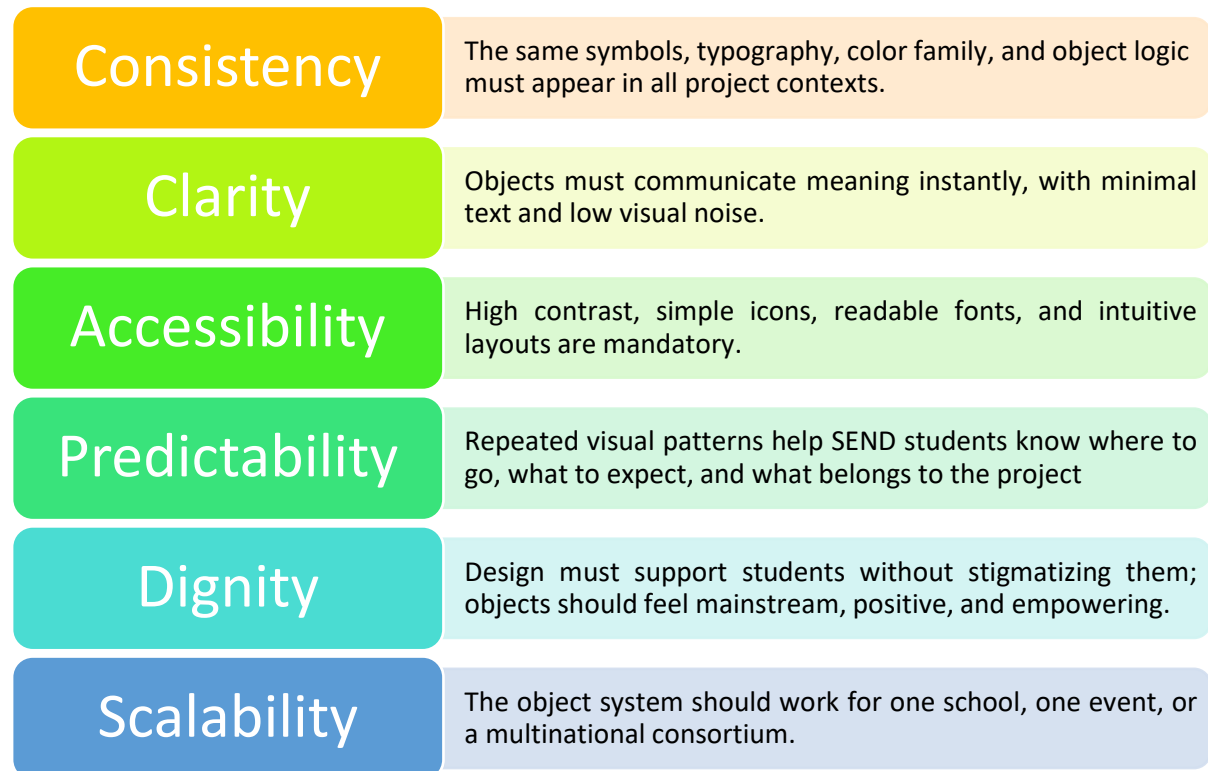


Figure 9 Design principles

4. Visual Identification Objects for students and SEND students

The strategy recommends a modular kit of objects. Each object serves both a visibility function and a SEND-support function. Table below recommend a set of objects that supports SEND students.

Object	Description	Value for visibility and SEND inclusion
Project logo system	Master logo plus simplified icon mark, monochrome version, high-contrast version, and child-friendly variant.	Ensures recognition in all print and digital situations; simplified variants support easier decoding.
Color-coded project zones	Use a limited palette to distinguish activity types: learning, support, creativity, mobility, relaxation, information.	Helps students associate spaces and functions without processing long explanations.
Pictogram family	Custom icons for classroom, break area, help point, quiet space, registration, workshop, toilets, exit, transport, digital help desk.	Improves wayfinding and reduces uncertainty.

Door signs and room plates	Standard A4/A3 visual templates with icon, title, schedule block, and responsible person.	Makes project spaces visibly branded and easier to identify.
Roll-up banners and welcome boards	Entrance-level objects with strong visual identity, clear logo placement, QR code, and key message.	Creates immediate external visibility and helps visitors orient themselves.
Student badges and staff lanyards	Color-coded badges with icons and plain-language role labels.	Supports recognition of safe contacts and reduces social ambiguity.
Activity cards	Visual cards indicating 'What happens now', 'What comes next', 'Who helps', and 'How long it lasts'.	Very useful for SEND learners who benefit from sequencing and routine cues.
Quiet-space markers	Discreet but visible signage for calm rooms, sensory corners, or decompression zones.	Shows that the project values wellbeing and inclusion.
Achievement stickers and participation passports	Small collectible identity objects linked to workshops, milestones, or mobility tasks.	Encourages motivation and gives the project a memorable learner-facing presence.
Presentation templates and social-media frames	Branded PowerPoint, poster, certificate, and post/story templates.	Extends visibility beyond the institution into digital dissemination.
Exhibition panels and poster stands	Photo-friendly panels explaining goals, outputs, partners, and student stories in plain language.	Supports stakeholder engagement and event-based visibility.
Merchandise with function	Notebook covers, tote bags, pencil cases, timetable sleeves, or desk flags using project graphics.	Creates durable low-cost visibility objects that remain in everyday use.

The general standards adopted by SMARTIE for visual and friendly use in order to support SEND students will contain the following:

- SMARTIE will use CALIBRI font with generous spacing and strong legibility
- SMARTIE will apply high contrast combinations and avoid visually noisy backgrounds
- SMARTIE will limit the number of colours used on one object; too many signals could overwhelm the SEND students. The palette of colours proposed will contain multiple colours but just for outline the logo in order to support inclusion.
- SMARTIE will create documents and presentations for SEND students by applying the methodology of pairing every major text message with an icon or pictorial cue
- SMARTIE will use short sentences, plain-language wording, and consistent terminology
- SMARTIE will use predictable placement of logos, icons, dates, QR codes, and contact information

5. Implementation phase, dissemination and visibility logic

During the dissemination activities, SMARTIE partners will test the visual identification objects with students, teachers, support staff and parents. Based on large audience feedback, the development of visual identification objects will follow an implementation model.

Implementation phase	Main actions
Phase 1 – Identity design	Define logo variants, icon family, color codes, and template rules.
Phase 2 – Prototype testing	Pilot selected objects with SEND students in real settings; collect quick feedback.
Phase 3 – Production	Print signage, badges, banners, cards, and digital assets for all partners.
Phase 4 – Deployment	Install objects in classrooms, event venues, mobility points, and online channels.
Phase 5 – Dissemination	Use the objects consistently in photo reports, conferences, social media, and stakeholder meetings.
Phase 6 – Review and upgrade	Measure recognition, usability, and emotional comfort; update the kit if needed.

The visual object system should not be treated as decoration. It should function as a dissemination engine. Every object must be designed so it can appear in photographs, videos, project reports, open days, study visits, partner meetings, and social-media posts.

- At events, objects must create a recognizable visual scene that clearly signals Erasmus+ participation.
- In classrooms and pilot actions, the same objects should make the project continuously present rather than visible only during formal dissemination moments.
- In digital communication, templates and visual frames must ensure that posts from different partners look related and mutually reinforcing.
- In community outreach, the objects should communicate inclusion and professionalism to parents, local authorities, NGOs, and school networks.

6. Monitoring Indicators

Indicator	Meaning	Suggested evidence
Recognition	Percentage of students/staff/stakeholders who can identify the project visually.	Short surveys, photo-based recognition checks
Accessibility	User feedback on readability, clarity, comfort, and usability of objects.	Observation sheets, SEND-focused interviews
Reach	Number of events, rooms, materials, and digital posts using the visual kit.	Internal dissemination logs
Engagement	Student participation in activities linked to badges, cards, or passports.	Attendance and participation records
Reputation	Perceived professionalism and inclusiveness of project communication.	Stakeholder feedback forms

13.5 Appendix 5. Strategy for workshops, conferences, webinars

This strategy establishes an integrated dissemination framework for organising workshops, conferences and webinars within an Erasmus+ project dedicated to the implementation of artificial intelligence in higher education. The strategy is designed to maximise visibility, engagement and long-term exploitation of project results, while ensuring that all dissemination activities remain inclusive, accessible and relevant to diverse audiences. It translates European priorities on digital education, inclusion and AI literacy into a practical event model that can be implemented by a project consortium throughout the project life cycle.

The proposed approach combines three complementary event formats. Workshops will be practice-oriented and competency-building, conferences will provide strategic visibility and multi-stakeholder dialogue, and webinars will ensure scalable, low-threshold outreach across Europe. Together, these instruments will support awareness raising, capacity building, peer learning, policy dialogue and community building around responsible AI adoption in higher education. Special attention is given to the meaningful participation of SEND students through universal design, accessible communication, multimodal content and hybrid participation options.

1. Introduction

The dissemination concept is grounded in the current European policy landscape. AI adoption in higher education is increasingly linked to the Digital Education Action Plan, the strengthening of digital skills and the emergence of AI literacy obligations under the AI Act. At Erasmus+ level, dissemination must do more than communicate project outputs; it should support exploitation, transferability, inclusion, visibility and systemic impact. Therefore, the organisation of dissemination events should not be treated as isolated promotional moments, but as a structured pathway that helps institutions, educators and learners move from awareness to experimentation, from experimentation to institutional uptake, and from institutional uptake to wider European cooperation.

This strategy also reflects Erasmus+ priorities related to inclusion and diversity. In practice, this means that event design, communication, logistics, language, digital platforms and learning materials must be planned so that participants with fewer opportunities, including SEND students, can genuinely access and benefit from the activities. The quality of dissemination is therefore measured not only by reach, but by relevance, usability, accessibility and the potential for sustained uptake after the project ends.

2. Strategic objectives

The main strategic objectives of this strategy are:

- to raise awareness of the pedagogical, organisational and ethical implications of AI in higher education;

- to build practical capacity among teachers, researchers and students for the responsible use of AI tools;
- to create inclusive dissemination environments in which SEND students can participate on an equal basis;
- to connect project results with institutional decision makers, policy communities and European networks;
- to generate public trust by explaining benefits, risks, safeguards and real educational use cases of AI;
- to strengthen the sustainability and transferability of Erasmus+ results beyond the consortium.

3. Target group and expected outcomes

Different target groups should not receive identical messages or identical event formats. The dissemination architecture must be audience-sensitive, with each event communicating a clear value proposition.

Target group	Main needs	Most suitable formats	Expected outcomes
Teachers	practical classroom applications, assessment redesign, academic integrity, accessible teaching methods	hands-on workshops, demonstration webinars, thematic conference panels	increased confidence and adoption of AI-enabled teaching practices
Researchers	research methods, ethics, data governance, AI-enhanced scholarly work, interdisciplinarity	expert workshops, scientific conferences, research webinars	cross-institutional collaboration and research visibility
Students	AI literacy, study support, employability, critical use of generative AI	interactive workshops, student webinars, mixed-audience conferences	better digital competence and informed use of AI tools
SEND students	accessible interfaces, multimodal learning support, inclusive participation and tailored guidance	small-group workshops, captioned webinars, inclusive conference sessions	greater participation, self-efficacy and equitable access to AI-enabled learning
General public	clear explanation of AI benefits, risks, safeguards and social value	public webinars, open conference sessions, outreach events	improved awareness and trust in educational innovation

4. Dissemination through workshops, conferences and webinars

The dissemination portfolio of SMARTIE will be organised as a layered ecosystem rather than a simple sequence of events. Each format performs a distinct function and supports a different step in the engagement journey.

4.1. Workshops

SMARTIE workshops are the main instrument for active learning and practice transfer. They will be organised in small or medium groups, preferably between 10 and 20 participants, and will include guided exercises, case studies, demonstrations and reflection activities.

- For teachers, topics will include AI-assisted lesson planning, assessment design, feedback generation, inclusive teaching and critical evaluation of AI outputs.
- For researchers, workshops will address literature mapping, coding support, qualitative analysis, reproducibility, ethics and responsible AI use in research workflows.
- For students, workshops will prioritise AI literacy, academic integrity, prompt design, fact-checking, source evaluation and employability-related applications.
- For SEND students-oriented workshops will include accessible interfaces, slower pacing when needed, multimodal explanation, assistive technology compatibility and opportunities for one-to-one support.

4.2. Conferences

Conferences serve as the flagship dissemination format. They provide visibility, legitimacy and networking opportunities at institutional, national and European levels. SMARTIE project conferences will combine plenary sessions, policy roundtables, research presentations, student voices and demonstrations of project outputs. It will also include at least one dedicated inclusion panel focused on equitable AI adoption and the experience of SEND students in higher education. Conferences are particularly suitable for engaging university managers, external stakeholders, NGOs, companies, national agencies, quality assurance bodies and representatives of the wider public. They will position the Erasmus+ project not only as a producer of outputs, but as a convenor of debate and a platform for informed exchange.

4.3. Webinars

SMARTIE webinars will be the most scalable dissemination format and are essential for continuity across the project timeline. They will reach transnational audiences at low cost, support multilingual circulation of knowledge and maintain momentum between major in-person events. Webinar design will privilege clarity, short segments, strong moderation, captioning, accessible slides, recorded replay and structured question-and-answer moments. An international webinar will be organised around progressive themes, covering:

- introduction to AI in higher education
- ethical and legal issues
- inclusive design
- classroom implementation
- research applications

- student perspectives
- institutional strategy
- exploitation of project results.

The timeline of the events is presented in Appendix 1. Dissemination Schedule and the results of dissemination activities can be consulted using Dissemination Tracker, the tool used for reporting process.

13.6 Appendix 6. Strategy to support European Initiatives related to adoption of AI in HE

1. Introduction

This document proposes a strategic framework for project partners involved in SMARTIE to support major European initiatives related to the adoption of artificial intelligence (AI) in higher education. The strategy starts from a review of the current European policy and implementation landscape and then translates that landscape into concrete partner-level actions. The central premise is that SMARTIE should not function only as an isolated Erasmus+ project, but as a practical support instrument that helps universities turn European ambitions into institutional practice.

The European landscape is currently shaped by a cluster of mutually reinforcing initiatives. The Digital Education Action Plan 2021–2027 provides the overarching vision of high-quality, inclusive and accessible digital education. The AI Act adds a concrete AI literacy obligation for providers and deployers of AI systems, making organisational competence development a matter of implementation and compliance rather than mere experimentation. European ethical guidance on the use of AI and data in education, the European Digital Education Hub, the European Universities Initiative, and institutional transformation instruments such as HEInnovate further define the operating environment for higher education institutions. Together, these initiatives point toward a model of AI adoption that is ethical, inclusive, evidence-based, interoperable and scalable across borders. Based on this context, the present strategy defines five pillars for action:

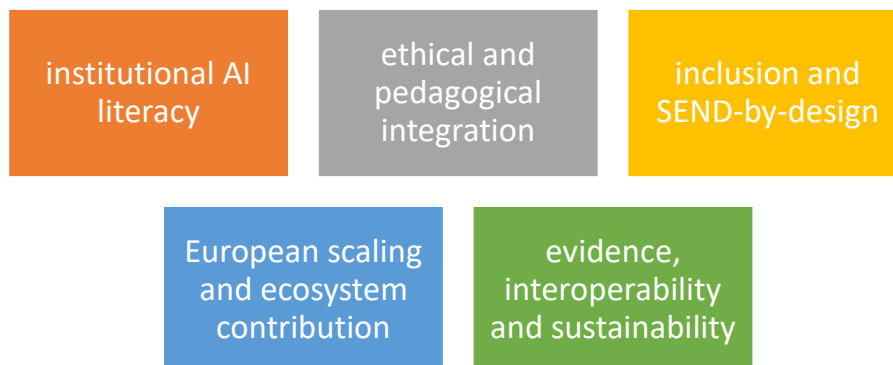


Figure 10 Pillars for supporting actions

The strategy also proposes differentiated roles for the SMARTIE partners. The University of Craiova is positioned as the policy-to-implementation coordinator; ACEEU as quality manager and benchmarking lead; Universidade de Lisboa as governance and institutional transformation lead; the University of Ljubljana and Politecnico di Bari as discipline-rich pedagogical pilot leaders; the University of Žilina as rollout and implementation engineering lead; the University of Málaga as student-facing adoption lead; FH OO Forschungs &

Entwicklungs GmbH as transfer and outreach broker; and Babeş-Bolyai University as inclusion and cross-disciplinary integration lead.

The document concludes with a cross-partner operating model, a partner action matrix, a proposed portfolio of flagship deliverables and a monitoring framework. Its intended use is practical: to guide work package planning, national and international dissemination, institutional pilot design and the long-term positioning of SMARTIE as a European support platform for responsible AI adoption in higher education.

2. Purpose and scope of the strategy

The purpose of this strategy is to provide a structured, partner-oriented framework that enables SMARTIE consortium members to support ongoing European initiatives related to AI adoption in higher education. The document is not limited to general advocacy in favour of AI. Instead, it is designed to help project partners align their activities with specific European policy instruments, implementation mechanisms and cooperation ecosystems. The scope of the strategy includes five complementary dimensions:

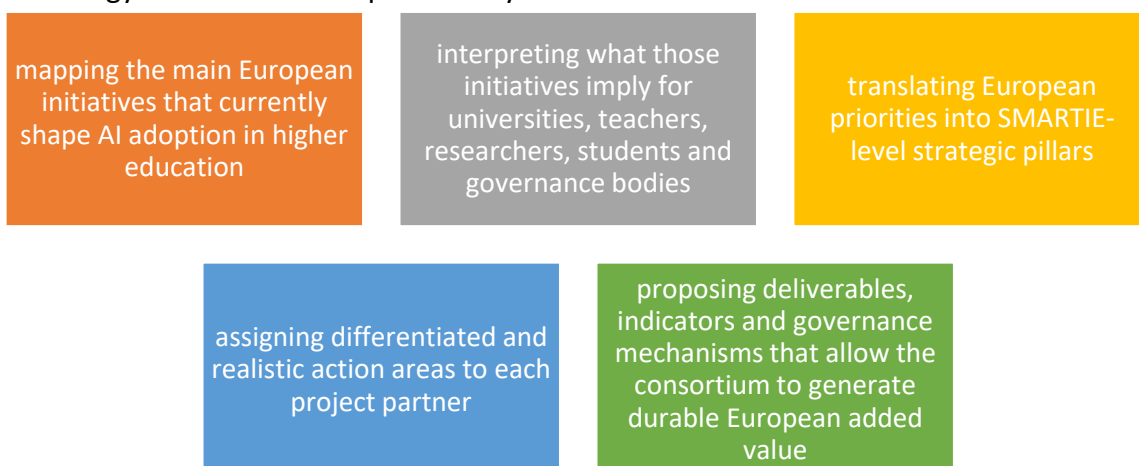


Figure 11 Complementary dimensions of SMARTIE actions

The strategy deliberately combines policy interpretation with institutional action. This is important because the European debate has shifted from exploratory discussions about AI to implementation questions concerning literacy, ethics, inclusion, assessment, governance and interoperability.

3. European initiative for AI in digital era

3.1. Digital Education Action Plan 2021–2027

The Digital Education Action Plan 2021–2027 establishes the broad European vision of high-quality, inclusive and accessible digital education. SMARTIE will lie in the fact that it links infrastructure, organisational capacity, digital pedagogy, digital competences and ecosystem cooperation. As a result, SMARTIE as an output of Erasmus+ project dealing

with AI in higher education will address both educational innovation and institutional transformation rather than treating AI as a stand-alone technological add-on.

3.2. AI Act and the AI literacy obligation

The AI Act significantly increases the practical importance of AI adoption strategies in universities. The Commission's guidance on Article 4 explains that organisations acting as providers or deployers of AI systems must ensure a sufficient level of AI literacy among staff and other persons dealing with those systems on their behalf. For higher education institutions, this creates a direct need for structured literacy pathways, differentiated training, role-sensitive guidance and evidence of implementation. This turns AI literacy into an institutional governance issue, not merely a topic for optional awareness sessions.

3.3. Ethical guidance on the use of AI and data in education

The European Commission's ethical guidance for educators on the use of AI and data provides a practical and normative reference point for educational institutions. Although initially addressed mainly to educators, the logic is directly relevant to higher education because it emphasises ethics, legal context, critical understanding, and responsible educational use. For SMARTIE, this means that guidelines, pilots and training materials should address human oversight, transparency, reliability, fairness and critical digital citizenship.

3.4. European Digital Education Hub

The European Digital Education Hub acts as a collaborative ecosystem for exchange, co-creation and scaling in digital education. It is strategically relevant because it offers a European-level space where project outputs can be translated into reusable resources, workshops, practice notes and policy-informed community contributions. SMARTIE will support European initiatives rather than simply cite them.

3.5. European Universities Initiative and university transformation agenda

The European strategy for higher education increasingly encourages structural cooperation, cross-border learning and long-term transformation through university alliances and international networks. This matters for AI adoption because successful models need to be transferable across institutional and national contexts. SMARTIE will produce methods, not local experiences, in order to add European.

3.6. HEInnovate and institutional change tools

HEInnovate remains an important European resource for institutional self-assessment and transformation planning in higher education. While not AI-specific, it offers a useful logic for maturity assessment, internal reflection and action planning. SMARTIE will use this as self-assessment tool on institutional readiness for responsible AI adoption.

3.7. Inclusion and accessibility in Erasmus+ and European education policy

European priorities on digital education and Erasmus+ place strong emphasis on inclusion, accessibility and participation for learners with fewer opportunities. In the SMARTIE context, this means that the project will continue explicitly design for SEND students and for accessibility in content, delivery, assessment and communication. Inclusion will be treated as a design principle and evaluation criterion throughout the project lifecycle.

4. SMARTIE alliance – actions for EU initiative

4.1. SMARTIE strategic objectives and actions for EU initiative

SMARTIE is a project running from October 2024 to September 2027 under Erasmus+ Cooperation Partnerships in Higher Education, coordinated by the University of Craiova and involving partners from Germany, Portugal, Slovenia, Slovakia, Italy, Spain and Romania. The stated objectives include a harmonised European approach to AI in education, accessible educational materials, inclusive teaching methods, AI-driven assessment, awareness-raising on opportunities and threats, and support for people with disabilities. This existing orientation is already well aligned with the European initiatives summarised above. However, the next strategic step is to move from broad alignment to operational contribution. SMARTIE will be organised so that each partner supports one or more European priorities through concrete activities, demonstrators, tools and dissemination outputs. The project will position itself as a European implementation partner for AI adoption in higher education.

Strategic objective:

Position SMARTIE as a practical European support platform that helps higher education institutions adopt AI in ways that are compliant, pedagogically sound, inclusive, interoperable and transferable across national systems.

The following guiding principles should govern all partner activities:

- European alignment: every major activity will map to at least one current European initiative, obligation or policy priority;
- institutional usefulness: outputs will solve practical problems faced by universities, not only produce descriptive reports;
- ethical responsibility: pilots and guidelines will explicitly address oversight, transparency, fairness, privacy and academic integrity;
- inclusion by design: SEND learners and other underrepresented groups will be considered from the start of each activity;
- transferability: methods and tools will be usable by institutions beyond the consortium;
- evidence orientation: success will be measured through institutional change, adoption quality and user outcomes rather than only through event counts.

4.1.1. SMARTIE actions for Pillar 1 - AI literacy as an institutional responsibility

SMARTIE alliance will build role-based AI literacy pathways for academic staff, researchers, professional staff, students and leadership. This directly supports the emerging European expectation that organisations using AI ensure a sufficient level of AI literacy. The alliance will produce a common literacy matrix, modular learning units, completion evidence mechanisms and a minimum implementation package adaptable to different universities.

4.1.2. SMARTIE actions for Pillar 2 - Ethical and pedagogical integration

The alliance will help universities redesign teaching and assessment with AI rather than merely encourage ad hoc tool use. This will include course-level policies, teacher guidance, student authorship rules, critical evaluation protocols, assessment redesign and practical examples of responsible use in different disciplines.

4.1.3. SMARTIE actions for Pillar 3 - Inclusion and SEND-by-design

Every output will satisfy a defined accessibility and inclusion checklist covering readable documents, captions, alternative text, multimodal learning resources, assistive-technology compatibility and flexible participation pathways. The strategic goal is to demonstrate that AI can reduce rather than increase educational barriers.

4.1.4. SMARTIE actions for Pillar 4 - European scaling and ecosystem contribution

SMARTIE alliance will package selected outputs for wider European use through communities of practice, institutional networks, webinars, workshops and dissemination assets that speak to both policy and practice. This will include contributions to European-level dialogue on AI in higher education and the creation of reusable implementation resources.

4.1.5. SMARTIE actions for Pillar 5 - Evidence, interoperability and sustainability

SMARTIE founders and new members will collect comparable evidence across institutions: literacy gains, policy adoption, staff confidence, student trust, accessibility outcomes, redesigned courses and stakeholder uptake. Results will be organised so they can support future cooperation, benchmarking and institutional continuity after the project ends.

4.2. Role of SMARTIE members/founders

4.2.1. University of Craiova (UCV)

University of Craiova will lead the translation of European frameworks into a common consortium operating model. Its main role is not only administrative coordination, but strategic orchestration. UCV should develop a master alignment matrix that links each SMARTIE activity to the Digital Education Action Plan, AI literacy expectations, ethical guidance, inclusion priorities and dissemination requirements. It should also convene biannual implementation reviews where each partner reports institutional changes achieved, not only tasks completed. UCV will coordinate the final policy synthesis and

a transferable European support roadmap based on consortium evidence. Priority actions of UCV:

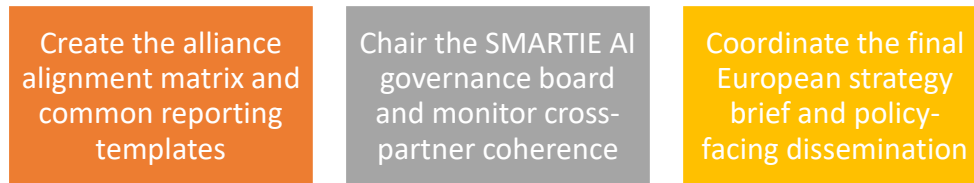


Figure 12 UCV roles and responsibilities

4.2.2. ACEEU GmbH (ACEEU)

ACEEU is quality manager of SMARTIE and attributes to it a major role in questionnaires, quality assurance, strategic agenda development, dissemination and impact assessment. This places ACEEU in an ideal position to lead the project's quality architecture. Its role will include the development of an institutional maturity framework on AI adoption, a benchmarking logic for comparing partner progress and a transferable self-assessment tool for universities beyond the consortium. Priority actions of ACEEU:

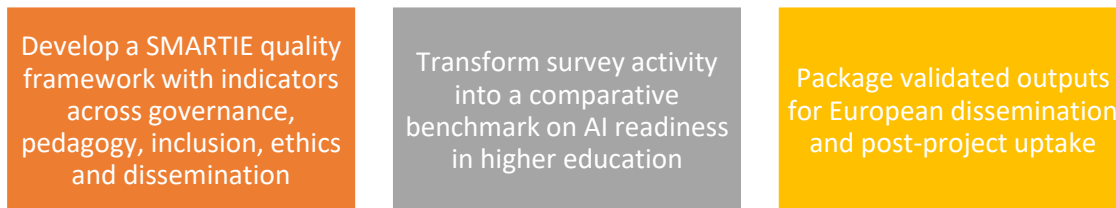


Figure 13 ACEEU roles and responsibilities

4.2.3. Universidade de Lisboa (ULISBOA)

The Universidade de Lisboa project page places SMARTIE within the Manufacturing and Industrial Management research group and presents the project objective as the responsible integration of AI into teaching, learning and governance. This makes ULISBOA particularly suitable to lead institutional governance use cases. Its work will focus on how AI can support university operations, curriculum planning, student-support processes and decision-making while respecting ethics, oversight and organisational accountability. Priority actions of ULISBOA:



Figure 14 ULISBOA roles and responsibilities

4.2.4. University of Ljubljana (UL)

The University of Ljubljana is involved in SMARTIE alliance as promoting innovative and student-centred teaching, accessible materials, inclusive methods and awareness of both the benefits and risks of AI. Given its strong disciplinary environment, UL will lead demonstrator pilots showing how AI can be integrated into technically demanding programmes without undermining academic rigour. Its contribution will focus on learning design, assessment integrity and high-value teaching scenarios in engineering and related disciplines. Priority actions of UL:



Figure 15 UL roles and responsibilities

4.2.5. University of Žilina (UZ)

The University of Žilina will be assigned with a practical implementation role centred on operational rollout. Its task will consist of converting the strategy into procedures that departments and faculties can actually use. This will include pilot selection methods, onboarding flows, support routines, escalation pathways and phased institutionalisation models. Priority actions of UZ:



Figure 16 UZ roles and responsibilities

4.2.6. Politecnico di Bari (POLIBA)

Politecnico di Bari will lead advanced staff-development and curriculum work in technical and engineering domains. Its added value lies in showing how AI can support higher-order disciplinary learning, technical feedback, design reasoning and data-aware teaching without replacing expert judgement. This is especially important in European discussions where universities need examples of academically robust integration rather than superficial use of generative tools. Priority actions of POLIBA:

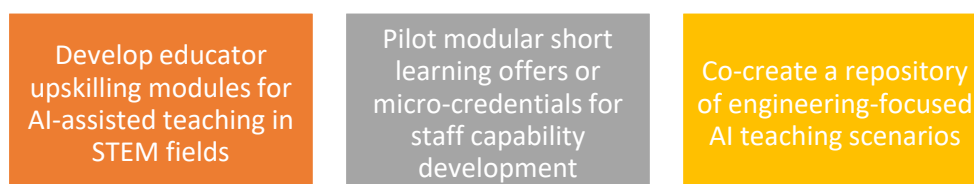


Figure 17 POLIBA roles and responsibilities

4.2.7. University of Málaga (UM)

The University of Málaga will lead the student-facing dimension of the strategy. European AI adoption in higher education will not succeed if students are positioned only as passive recipients of staff decisions. Instead, universities need student charters, peer-learning mechanisms, guidance on acceptable use and channels for structured student feedback on trust, fairness and usefulness. UM will lead this participatory dimension. Priority actions of UM:

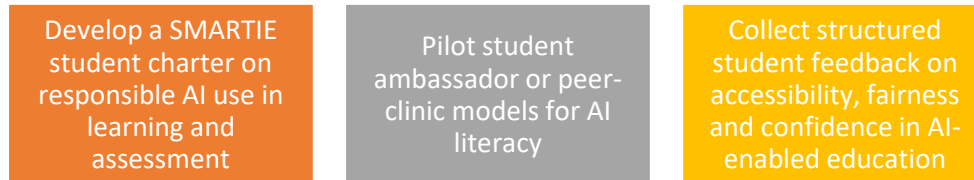


Figure 18 UM roles and responsibilities

4.2.8. FH OO Forschungs & Entwicklungs GmbH (FHOO)

SMARTIE dissemination materials hosted by FHOO explicitly refer to national workshops, an international webinar and a European strategy for AI integration in higher education. FHOO is therefore well positioned to act as transfer and outreach broker. Its role will be to connect consortium outputs with practitioner communities, external stakeholders, leadership audiences and cross-border learning spaces. Priority actions of FHOO:

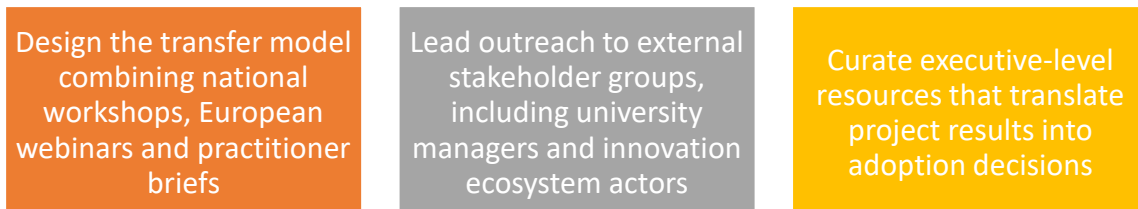


Figure 19 FHOO roles and responsibilities

4.2.9. Babeş-Bolyai University (UBB)

Babeş-Bolyai University will lead the inclusion and disciplinary diversification strand of the project. A robust European AI-in-HE strategy must work not only in technical faculties but also across social sciences, humanities and teacher education. At the same time, it must address accessibility and participation for SEND students and other learners with fewer opportunities. UBB can ensure that the project does not remain narrow or technocentric. Priority actions of FHOO:

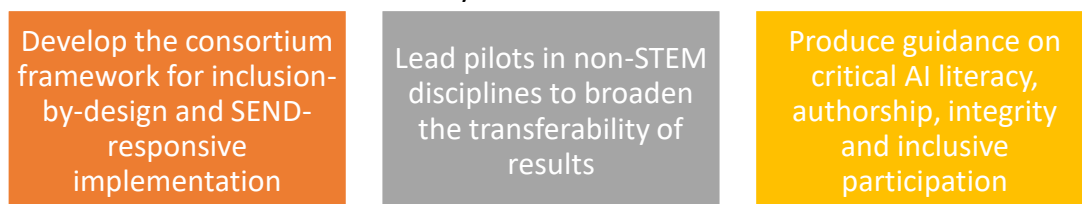


Figure 20 UBB roles and responsibilities

The SMARTIE alliance matrix actions can be summarized as follows:

Partner	Strategic role	Key actions	European initiatives mainly supported
University of Craiova	Coordinator; policy-to-implementation lead	Alignment matrix; governance board; final strategy brief	DEAP; AI literacy; European scaling
ACEEU	Quality, benchmarking and dissemination architecture	Quality framework; survey benchmark; self-assessment tool	AI literacy; quality assurance; dissemination
Universidade de Lisboa	Governance and institutional transformation	Governance use cases; deployment templates; institutional change models	Responsible AI governance; digital transformation
University of Ljubljana	Pedagogical pilots in technical education	Engineering pilots; assessment integrity guidance; teaching scenarios	Ethical AI use; pedagogy; transferable practice
University of Žilina	Implementation engineering and rollout	Rollout handbook; AI adoption sprint; operational procedures	Institutional uptake; operationalisation
Politecnico di Bari	Advanced STEM upskilling and curriculum support	Staff modules; micro-learning offers; STEM scenario repository	Digital skills; curriculum innovation
University of Málaga	Student-facing adoption and participation	Student charter; peer clinics; student feedback systems	AI literacy; participation; trust and fairness
FH OO F&E GmbH	Transfer, outreach and ecosystem brokerage	National workshops; webinars; executive briefs	European scaling; stakeholder engagement
Babeş-Bolyai University	Inclusion, SEND and cross-disciplinary integration	SEND framework; non-STEM pilots; critical AI literacy guidance	Inclusion and diversity; accessibility; ethics

5. Conclusions

European AI adoption in higher education has entered a phase in which broad policy ambition must be translated into credible institutional practice. The European framework now expects universities to combine literacy, ethics, inclusion, pedagogy, governance and cooperation in a coherent response. SMARTIE is well placed to contribute to this agenda because its publicly stated aims already combine AI integration, accessibility, assessment innovation, awareness-raising and support for people with disabilities. The strategic added value of the consortium will depend on whether each partner adopts a distinct and complementary role. If the consortium follows the partner-specific division of responsibilities proposed in this document, SMARTIE can function as more than a project consortium: it can become a European support platform that helps universities operationalise current European initiatives. Such a positioning would strengthen dissemination, improve sustainability and increase the long-term relevance of project outputs for institutions beyond the partnership.